'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Summer 2019

Annual Meeting & Election

by Rusty McCrady, Nominating Committee Chair



It's that time of year! CMA Elections! Here's your chance to throw your hat in the ring and use your amazing talents to help manage the Association. No experience is necessary. You'll need to give a few hours a month for meetings and Association business, but you'll have a direct impact on the community and the heartfelt appreciation of our owner/members. Details on the Board's responsibilities can by found in the CMA ByLaws – available on the website in the Owners/Documents section.

The Board consists of seven elected members, each elected for a two-year term, running January to December. This year, there are four positions expiring and one resignation – making **five positions open for election in September**. To be eligible, an Association member must be in good standing (assessments up to date) and be nominated to run. You can certainly self-nominate. Nominations should be submitted to Rusty McCrady. This can be a simple email noting your request to be included in the slate of candidates. We ask that you submit a short candidate statement – about 150 words – which will be distributed to membership with the election materials. Please send your statement by email to Rusty no later than August 15, if you'd like your statement included in the information sent to members. Of course, nominations will also be accepted at the Annual Meeting on September 21. Those candidates must be present at the meeting to accept the nomination.

Again this year, we'll be using an online system to facilitate voting for the election. You will receive information about the candidates and the proposed 2020 CMA Annual Budget by September 1. It will include information on how to cast your vote using the online system. Of course, you can also vote on candidates and the proposed budget at the Annual Meeting. Online and in-person voting will be tabulated and the results announced at the Annual Meeting.

We hope you will consider serving on the Board – it's a valuable and rewarding experience.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Board of Directors Meeting	August 3, 2019, 10:00 am	CMA Office
Pot Luck Dinner	August 3, 2019, 6:00 pm	The Wohl's, E-4
Labor Day Barbecue	September 2, TBD	CMA Barn
Annual Membership Meeting	September 21, 10:00 am	CMA Barn
Annual Members' Dinner	September 21, 6:00 pm	CMA Barn
Halloween Party	Date/Time TBD	CMA Barn
Board of Directors Meeting	November 9, 10:00 am	CMA Office

Security Corner

by Cathy Levey, Security Committee Chair

Coolfont Mountainside is a small community rich in diversity and a 50-year history. Our community is comprised of 118 homes - 13 of which are full time residents, about 41 are rental cabins and the rest are second homes used part-time.

Rental properties are handled either by a rental agent or directly by the owner. In either case, they may use online services such as VRBO or Airbnb to solicit rentals. Additionally, owners may seek the services of a property manager to oversee their second home in their absence.

So, who do you call if there's a disturbance in our quiet and peaceful community?

Maybe bears have topped your neighbor's trash and dragged it all over the property. Perhaps there are fireworks going off at the house up the street. Or, a group of renters next door are loud and disruptive late at night

Certainly, noise issues between 11:00 p.m. and 6:00 a.m. can be handled by calling 911, and local law enforcement will respond during those hours. Local law enforcement, however, will not respond to enforce our covenants where no local ordinances exist, such as setting off fireworks in the community.

The Association does not maintain a list of rental properties with the respective rental agents. Therefore, a resident seeking relief must contact the property owner to report their concern. Certainly, the two neighbors are then welcome to make arrangements to share rental agent contact information for any future concerns.

If a resident has bseen unsuccesful in contacting the owner of the rental property, they may contact our security committee. The security team will also try to reach the property owner and, if possible, the rental agent. Residents can reach Cathy Levey, Security Committee Chair, at 304-258-5481 or mccm2012@hotmail.com.



Fortunately, incidents requiring owner notification are few and far between, but should an event occur, we ask that owners understand the need to contact them about issues that arise.

On a separate note: Neighborhood Watch Patrols are proven to reduce crime activity in communities and neighborhoods. There are less theft-related insurance claims in communities where a Neighborhood Watch is in place. You might want to contact your insurance agent to see if our active daily patrols in the community reduce your insurance premiums.

Wishing you all a safe and pleasant summer!



A very special thank you to Rosemary Bigelow (O-4) and Valerie Creason (F-2) for their generous donations. They gifted a beautiful podium, table and four folding chairs to the Association. These will be put to good use at CMA events!

The Pool's So Cool!

by Dawne Holz

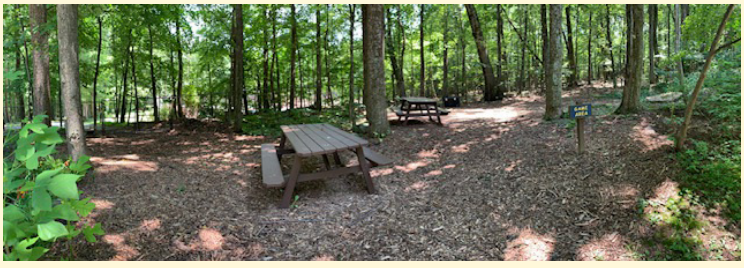
The May 18 Pool Clean Up Day was a big success! Big thanks to our volunteers - the pool looks wonderful! We had about 20 people who helped the site managers tackle a bunch of work:

- Painting picnic benches and railings
- Pulling weeds, raking leaves, pruning trees and shrubs, clearing fallen branches
- Cleaning out clogged drains on the deck and in the lawn
- Powerwashing the entire deck and stone wall
- Rebuilding front entrance step
- Spreading a giant pile of wood chips in the upper picnic and game area
- Updating the bulletin board and signage

In addition, the site manager's have had the flagstone mortar joints repaired and the overhead motion sensor lights replaced, increasing security for the area. They also added some potted shrubs and flowers. Still in the works are fixes to the lighting in and around the pool.

We've received many positive comments from members and guests. Be sure to check out the pool before the end of the season - which is fast approaching. Bring your pool pass.

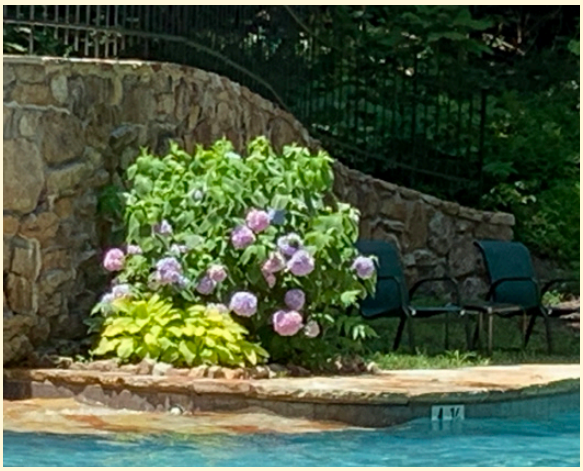
The pool will close for the season at the end of the day on Labor Day, Monday, September 2. Please save your pool pass for next year.



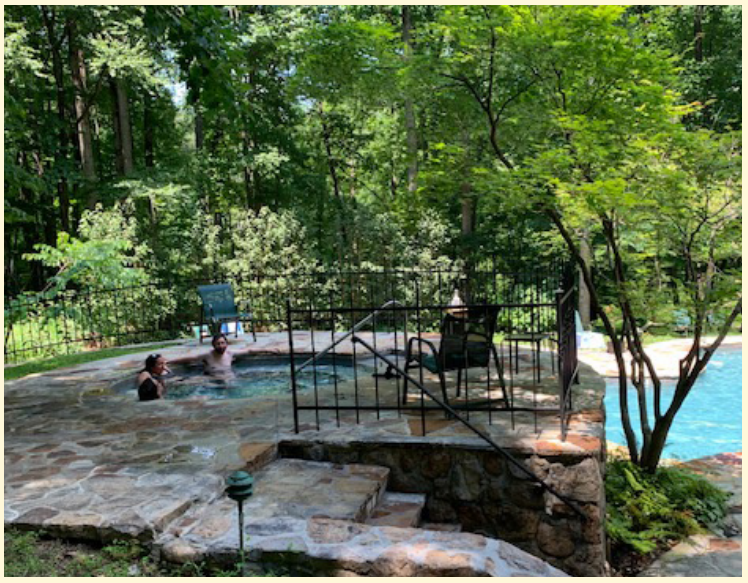
Picnic tables painted, on a bed of new, dry wood chips



Powerwashed: Flagstone deck is sparkling clean.



Thanks to excellent pruning by Leila Keese, our "Endless Summer" hydrangea looks beautiful!



Upper deck around the hot tub got a good cleaning, too!

A Visit to Berkeley Springs State Park Baths

by Liz Dane

Over the years when I bring a friend to get a massage and sit in the warm baths, I always offer this disclaimer: "Don't expect an Elizabeth Arden experience - think more like the 'glamping' version of a massage."

No, it still isn't Elizabeth Arden but, to my delight, there have been some noticeable improvements.

Recently, I made reservations for myself and an out of town guest. I noticed something different right away. A lovely young woman answered the phone oozing with a friendly tone and serious hospitality.

She informed us that all she had that day were male masseuses. We were ok with that. When we arrived, we were greeted warmly by the new front desk attendant. Gone are the surly women that were there in the past. We were brought into what used to be the men's side of baths and informed that the baths and massage areas all now geared to both sexes. However, you still change in private areas.



The bath experience was the same. If you haven't experienced the baths, you must! The water comes directly from the springs that are filtered through the mountain. The state park has seven springs that they draw from. The water from the springs is at a constant 74 degrees. However, they increase the temperature for the baths to a cool 102 degrees. After the bath, you can opt for a massage. In the past, your massage consisted of someone rubbing olive oil over you. There was a lot of chatter by the attendant and you walked out feeling like a salad.

The massage I had this time was heavenly! The attendant informed me that all the attendants now must be certified massage therapists. That is a huge difference.



What other changes at the bath house?

- $1.2 million renovation of the Old Roman Bath house, scheduled to open in August
- The bath house now offers couples massages
- They are working on getting WATSU massage certification via their Aquatic Body Work Program
- Hot wax hand massages
- Cupping Treatments
- Prenatal massages

The most exciting news is that once the new lodge is built at Cacapon State Park, they will be offering full spa services there. Facials, manicures and pedicures... Oh my!

Can't wait! Maybe Elizabeth Arden will have a run for its money in Berkeley Springs.

If you are interested in making a reservation for the bath and massage, call 304-258-2711. They can give you a list of services and prices.

Save $$$!

Just a reminder that Morgan County provides a nice discount if you pay your property, fire and ambulance taxes before September 1. For information on your tax bills and the early payment discount, contact the Morgan County Sheriff's Tax Office at 304-258-8562.

Wildlife As CMA Sees It

















Clockwise from upper left: Coyote, Jonathan Keiler (S-5); Road Racer, Dawne Holz (F-1); Bear Visit, Holz; Doe with fawn, Keiler; Bear family, Keiler; Grey fox with a catch, Keiler; This is empty, Holz; Turkeys foraging, Keiler.

Gravel at your feet

by Dawne Holz

You just put down new gravel and your driveway looks great! Now, how do you keep it looking that way? Gravel driveways typically require less maintenance than asphalt or concrete, but do require proper care. Over time, gravel can shift or loosen or become clogged with weeds, leaves and twigs. Untreated, this can eventually lead to potholes, ruts and other issues. Keep an eye on the condition of your driveway and prevent problems before they start. Here are a few tips:

Remove Debris - With our beautiful forest comes leaves and twigs - lots of them. Use a rake or blower to keep your driveway clear. The longer you put off removing leaves, sticks and debris from the gravel, the more time-consuming and difficult the task will be. This debris can break down and "clog" your gravel, reducing traction and ultimately burying the gravel under newly created soil.

Kill Weeds - Not only are weeds unsightly, they can rapidly turn your gravel driveway back into forested understory. Keep weeds in check with a non-specific weed killer spray. You can make your own natural - and economical - version with household items. See recipe at right.

Fill Pot holes - Pot holes and ruts will get worse if you ignore them. Resist the temptation to shovel gravel from one area of the driveway to the problem spot. This creates more weak spots that could lead to further damage down the road. Filling in the pothole with new gravel is the best fix.

Watch the spread - Over time, vehicular and foot traffic can cause gravel to move and end up beyond the original edge of the driveway. To keep gravel in place, consider lining the edges with stones - there are plenty to be found.

Check Your Speed – Driving fast on your driveway can dislodge loose gravel and can lead to unnecessary and prematurely thinned-out areas of the driveway.

Gravel driveway maintenance doesn't have to involve back-breaking labor. With a little TLC, your gravel driveway will look great for years.

Make your own weed killer!

1/4 cup of gin (use the cheap stuff)
1/4 cup of white vinegar
1/4 cup of baby shampoo
1 gallon of water

Mix all in a pump sprayer and drench the weeds. Be careful not to spray on plants you want to keep. Stubborn weeds may need a second dose several days later.

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors
Jennifer Hughes, President
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Sharon Geno, Vice President
Joan Claybrook, Secretary
Eileen Neely, Treasurer
Liz Dane, Director
Tom Holz, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

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Website
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User ID: owner Password: coolfont

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cma-members@googlegroups.com

Listserv Signup/Web
groups.google.com/forum/#!forum/cma-members

Facebook
www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406

Lost!

Bucket of sand, silt and gravel.

Has great sedimental value.

Firewise Update
by Cathy Levey, FireWise Coordinator

As of July 10, we have received 20 completed risk assessment forms with only 98 to go! Many thanks to those of you who have sent a completed form or have provided permission to complete the form on your behalf.

As a reminder, the new Firewise requirements include an updated risk assessment within five years of 2018 and an updated action plan every three years for continued membership. Additionally, we are still collecting any volunteer hours spent on fire risk reduction at individual homes and in the general community. Any completed risk assessment forms, permission to complete the form on your behalf (granting access to the outside of your property) and volunteer hours may be sent to Cathy Levey at mccm2012@hotmail.com.

Many thanks to all of you for your continued support of the safety and well being of the community!

Rules and Regulations: Parking

Section III: Use of Roads and Driveways

Roadway Parking Limitations: Residents are asked not to park on the CMA roadways or common ground except in specified parking areas. In emergency (snow) conditions, roadside parking may be necessary but residents are asked to park so as not to block access by emergency and/or snow removal vehicles.

Residential Parking: Each residence may provide one parking space for each bedroom, or room readily used as a bedroom; with a minimum of two and maximum of six parking spaces including parking spaces in carports or garages. Overnight parking of more than the permitted number of vehicles is not permitted. No vehicle larger that a step van may be parked on a lot.

Trailers, Boats and Outside Storage: Trailers, RVs, ATVs, truck campers, trailers and trailered boats are not permitted to be parked on residential lots, driveways or CMA common ground. Materials, tools, equipment, etc. may not be stored on lots, driveways or on common ground. Vehicles displaying advertising may only be parked in a garage or screened carport.

Full document online: CMA Basic Rules – 02-2007



After 11 years of making marvelous memories at our cozy cabin, "Inn2thewoods" in the Coolfont Mountainside Community it's sadly time to say goodbye. On Labor Day Weekend, August 31 and September 1, we will be hosting two open houses. We invite you, our Coolfont neighbors, to the exclusive neighbor open house event on Saturday, August 31 from 11-12. Refreshments will be served. Please spread the word and bring your weekend guests. The house will go on the market in early September. For more information please contact Lesley Frowick at 240-447-2887 or lesley@wcorwin.com. See you there!



Board Shorts

[Editor: Due to space, Board Shorts was not included in the Spring 2019 newsletter.]

There was no Board Meeting in February.

March 16 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of January 12, meeting.
- Motion approved to initiate use of an Association credit card for purchases, with internal controls.
- The Board upheld the decision of the DACC on an application denial, and recommended the resident/DACC work to find a solution.
- Repairs were made to the North Water System and a resident water meter. The chlorination solution tanks were replaced.
- Bids are being solicited for rewiring the South Well to the South Pump House.

April 13 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of March 16 meeting.
- Motion approved to grant a waiver of Barn rental fee, special circumstances.
- Motion approved for funding for gravel improvements for roads.
- Security Committee reported there were several bear vs. trash bin encounters.
- Firewise Committee has started work on required community assessment.

May 18 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of April 13 meeting.
- Motion approved for $625 for Barn electric repairs
- Motion approved for $6,000 for Barn fire system repairs and required upgrades
- Motion approved for $700 for Pool lighting repairs (security/landscaping lighting)
- Motion approved for $15,000 for Road repairs and maintenance (grading, ditch clearing, culvert repairs, gravel)

June 29 Board Meeting

- Motion approved for $1,000 for additional smoke detectors required for the Barn
- Finance Committee directed to turn over three delinquent accounts to the attorney for collection

There was no Board Meeting in July.

See Something, Say Something

If you see something in the community that needs attention - pot hole, tree down, vandalism, trash mess or other concern - contact the site manager at 304-671-0882 or email to almostheavenpm1@gmail.com.

Make a Difference

The following committees are in need of a chair person. Please consider volunteering a few hours a month for our community.

Firewise Organizer:

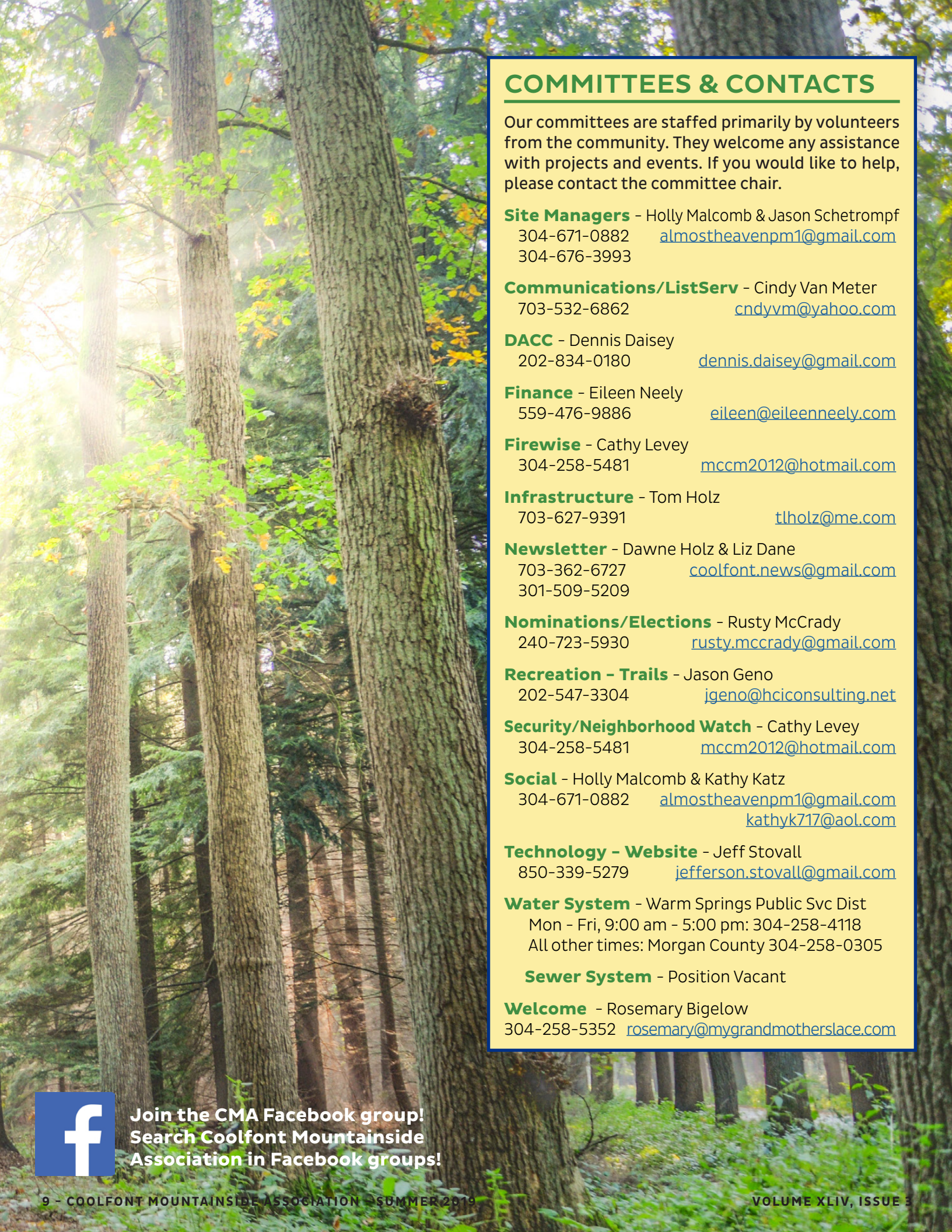
The National Firewise Communities Program provides wildland/urban interface resources for firefighter safety, community planning, landscaping, construction, and maintenance to help protect people, property, and natural resources from wildland fire. As the contact person for Firewise, your role would be to complete a risk assessment and action plan for the CMA community as part of renewal requirements as well as collect volunteer hours involving fire risk reduction activities towards the annual renewal application due in November of each year.
Average monthly hours: 2.

When preparing the risk assessment/action plan, possibly 10 per month.

Security Committee:

As chair of security, you would oversee Neighborhood Watch Patrols, maintaining a log of daily patrols, and address any security issues that arise, such as noise concerns, trash issues and outside security lights complaints. You would work with a group of volunteers doing patrols during the week and on weekends.
Average monthly hours: 20.

If you're interested in helping your community in any of these committee leads, or would like more information, please contact Cathy Levey.



COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed primarily by volunteers from the community. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Managers - Holly Malcomb & Jason Schetrompf
304-671-0882 almostheavenpm1@gmail.com
304-676-3993

Communications/ListServ - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Eileen Neely
559-476-9886 eileen@eileenneely.com

Firewise - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Infrastructure - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

Newsletter - Dawne Holz & Liz Dane
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
301-509-5209

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Recreation – Trails - Jason Geno
202-547-3304 jgeno@hciconsulting.net

Security/Neighborhood Watch - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Social - Holly Malcomb & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 almostheavenpm1@gmail.com
kathyk717@aol.com

Technology – Website - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

Water System - Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Sewer System - Position Vacant

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Join the CMA Facebook group!
Search Coolfont Mountainside Association in Facebook groups!